

Discrete logarithm

Module I

Logarithm

Can you Compute

$$2^5 = 32$$

Can you compute $3^? = 129140163$

Answer – 17

We can also write

$$5 = \log_2(32) \quad 17 = \log_3(129140163)$$

In general

$$p^i = q$$

$$i = \log_p(q)$$

Modular Arithmetic

Can you compute this

$$9 = 3^4 \pmod{12}$$

$$26067 = 14^i \pmod{29867}$$

$$26067 = 14^{12} \pmod{29867}$$

$$4 = \text{dlog}_{3,12}(9)$$

$$12 = \text{dlog}_{14,29867}(26067)$$

In General

$$a = b^i \pmod{m}$$

$$i = \text{dlog}_{b,m}(a)$$

More Examples

- Compute

$$2^5 \bmod 3 = 2$$

$$4^4 \bmod 11 = 3$$

Can you compute this ?

$$8 = 5^i \bmod 13 - \text{determine } i$$

$$\text{or } i = \text{dlog}_{5,13}(8)$$

$$\text{Ans} - 3 = \text{dlog}_{5,13}(8) \quad \text{or}$$

$$8 = 5^3 \bmod 13$$

Check this one

$$? = 5^7 \bmod 13 \quad \text{and} \quad ? = 5^{11} \bmod 13$$

- We should consider cases only when dlog gives us a unique answer
- Only then we can use dlog in our algorithms

Primitive Roots

$$a = \underbrace{b^i}_{\text{unique}} \pmod m$$

$$i = \text{dlog}_{b,m}(a)$$

*b should be
primitive root
of
prime
m*

We can get an unique value of i if b is a primitive root of prime modulo m

What is a primitive root ?

Primitive Root

$a = b^i \pmod{m}$ (consider $m=13$)

b	b^1	b^2	b^3	$b^4 \pmod{m}$	b^5	b^6	b^7	b^8	b^9	b^{10}	b^{11}	$b^{12} \pmod{m}$
1 ✓	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2 ✓	2	4	8	3	6	12	11	9	5	10	7	1
3	3	9	1	3	9	1	3	9	1	3	9	1
4 ✗	4	3	12	9	10	1	4	3	12	9	10	1
5 ✗	5	12	8	1	5	12	8	1	5	12	8	1
6 ✓	6	10	8	9	2	12	7	3	5	4	11	1
7 ✓	7	10	5	9	11	12	6	3	8	4	2	1
8 ✗	8	12	5	1	8	12	5	1	8	12	5	1
9 ✗	9	3	1	9	3	1	9	3	1	9	3	1
10 ✗	10	9	12	3	4	1	10	9	12	3	4	1
11 ✓	11	4	5	3	7	12	2	9	8	10	6	1
12 ✗	12	1	12	1	12	1	12	1	12	1	12	1

Definition

Primitive Root

- If b is a primitive root of $\text{mod } m$ where m is a prime number then $b^1 \text{ mod } m, b^2 \text{ mod } m, b^3 \text{ mod } m \dots b^{m-1} \text{ mod } m$ are distinct values

Discrete Logarithm –

If a is an arbitrary integer relatively prime to m and b is a primitive root of m , then there exists exactly one number i such that

$$a = b^i \pmod{m}$$

The number i is then called the discrete logarithm of a with respect to the base b modulo m and is denoted

$$i = \text{dlog}_{b,m}(a)$$

Check if 5 is primitive root of mod 7?

Exercise

- Check if 5 is a primitive root of mod 7 ?

$$i = \text{dlog}_{b,m}(a) \quad \text{or} \quad a = \underbrace{b^i}_{\text{base}} \pmod{m} \quad \text{power}$$

Determine i when a , b and m are given

**Finding Discrete Logarithm for Large
Numbers will be difficult**

Exercise

- $? = \text{dlog}_{17,2111}(1922)$
- $1922 = 17^i \pmod{2111}$ 7 2048 bits

Ans = 12